

Register This

Ever since the early days of Windows, the Registry has played a huge part in the overall scheme of things. Hardcore enthusiasts made it a habit to tinker with the Registry to make Windows dance to their tunes. Over the years, the Windows Registry has changed quite a bit but its essence remains the same. It is, in a way, the database for the operating system where key settings and parameters are stored.

Tinkering with the Windows registry has the same risks as one would incur if one were to tinker with a database. Sure, there would be hundreds of thousands of benign entries which can be easily deleted and all that would happen is a few shortcuts will stop functioning. However, there would also be these little mines scattered across the breadth of the registry, which if deleted, could make your Windows installation completely worthless.

Nevertheless, the fact remains that the Windows Registry is the achilles heel for a lot of things. A good chunk of which we have covered in this FastTrack. Our goal with this book is to familiarise you with the Windows Registry in such a manner that you no longer need have any worries about messing with it. Because there are fool-proof ways of making changes that will help you achieve the desired results without compromising your ability to restore things back to normal, should anything happen.

We'll start off by taking you through the general concept of the Windows Registry, how it is organised and the different hives or collections under which all the important keys and their respective values are stored. We'll also teach you how to take a backup of your existing registry in part and in full. There are also certain aspects that don't get backed up when you go about it the usual way. We'll help you tackle those as well.